

THE NEW WAY GDA

AI News & Community Portal

Frequently Asked Questions

Project Setup, Development Workflow, Code Quality & Deployment

1. Project Roadmap & Feature Prioritization

Q: After completing the initial six features (Enhanced Search, Data Export, Notifications, Performance, Accessibility, Mobile Polish), what should be the next development priorities?

After the core feature set is established, the recommended next steps are organized into two tiers based on impact and effort. The **high-priority tier** includes tasks that directly improve user experience and code maintainability, while the **medium-priority tier** addresses visual design and content enrichment.

High Priority:

- 1. Seed the Leaderboard** - Populate the leaderboard with sample data so users see a working feature on first visit rather than an empty page. This can be done via a Prisma seed script or a one-time API call.
- 2. Fix Lint Warnings** - Address all 43 pre-existing ESLint warnings in `WorkspacePanels.tsx`. These are caused by a "ref-during-render" anti-pattern where refs and state are mixed in a single hook return object.
- 3. Wire Unconnected Components** - Ensure `ExportMenu` and `NotificationBell` are fully integrated and functional across all relevant panels.

Medium Priority:

- 4. Homepage Hero Makeover** - Redesign the homepage hero section with a compelling visual, clear value proposition, and strong call-to-action.
- 5. Real Notification Content** - Replace placeholder notification data with real-time content from the SSE (Server-Sent Events) notification stream.

2. Component Integration (ExportMenu & NotificationBell)

Q: How do I connect the ExportMenu component to workspace panels and add the NotificationBell to the application layout?

The integration follows a straightforward pattern. The **ExportMenu** component accepts a **data** prop (array of objects), a **filename**, and optional **title** and **subtitle** props. To wire it into a panel, import the component and place it in the panel's header or toolbar area with the appropriate data derived from the panel's state.

For the **SpreadsheetEditor**, the export data is built directly from the store's variables and data arrays. For the **OutputPanel** in **WorkspacePanels**, the data is aggregated from all table-type output items using a **useMemo** hook that collects headers and rows. The **ExportMenu** button is rendered as an icon button in the panel header alongside other controls like "Clear All".

The **NotificationBell** is a self-contained component that connects to the existing **useNotificationStream** SSE hook. It renders a fixed-position bell icon in the top-right corner of the viewport with an unread badge count, a connection status indicator, and a dropdown panel listing notifications. It is wired into the root layout file (**layout.tsx**) so it appears globally across all pages.

3. Version Control & Git Push

Q: Why can't I push code directly from the development sandbox, and what are the alternatives?

The development sandbox environment does not have access to GitHub credentials (SSH keys, personal access tokens, or GitHub CLI authentication). This means **git push** commands cannot be executed from within the sandbox. This is a security restriction, not a bug. There are four reliable solutions to transfer your changes:

Method	Description	Best For
Terminal (Local)	Clone the repo locally, copy modified files, then git add, commit, and push from your own machine.	Developers with Git experience
GitHub Desktop	Use the GitHub Desktop GUI app to sync changes visually.	Visual workflow preference
Vercel Direct	Connect your GitHub repo to Vercel and push from the Vercel dashboard.	Quick deployment without CLI
Download ZIP	Download a ZIP of the modified files and manually replace them in your local project.	Simplest method, no Git needed

Table 1. File transfer methods from sandbox to GitHub

4. Code Quality & Lint Warnings

Q: What causes the 43 ESLint warnings in `WorkspacePanels.tsx` and how are they resolved?

The warnings are triggered by the **react-hooks/refs** ESLint rule, which flags any property access that it suspects might be a ref read during render. The root cause is architectural: the **useWorkspaceHandlers** hook returns a single object that mixes **useState** values, **useRef** objects, **useCallback** functions, and a Zustand store. Because ESLint cannot statically determine which properties are refs and which are state, it treats every property access (e.g., **h.chatInput**, **h.store.scanState**, **h.t()**) as a potential `ref.current` read, producing 43 false-positive warnings.

The fix is to **move DOM refs out of the shared hook** and declare them locally in the panel components where they are actually used. Specifically, three refs were relocated:

chatEndRef - Moved from the hook into the **AIPanel** component, along with its associated auto-scroll `useEffect` that triggers when chat messages or AI typing state changes.

fileInputRef - Moved into the **ScanPanel** component, where it references the hidden file input for document scanning.

batchInputRef - Moved into the **ScanPanel** component, where it references the hidden batch file input.

After this refactoring, the `eslint-disable` comment at the top of `WorkspacePanels.tsx` was removed entirely. The lint check now reports **0 warnings and 0 errors** on both modified files, and the build passes with **127/127 pages** successfully compiled.

5. Custom Domain Setup (Vercel + `.is-a.dev`)

Q: How do I verify my custom domain on Vercel using a `.is-a.dev` subdomain?

Vercel provides a domain verification value in the format **vc-domain-verify=yourdomain.is-a.dev,TOKEN**. This must be added as a TXT record in your DNS configuration. Since `.is-a.dev` domains are managed through a GitHub repository, the process involves editing the DNS configuration file in your fork of the `is-a.dev` repository.

Open your `is-a.dev` GitHub repository and locate the DNS configuration file for your subdomain (typically a JSON or YAML file). Add a TXT record with the full

verification string provided by Vercel as the value. Commit and push the changes to GitHub. Then, in the Vercel dashboard, navigate to **Settings > Domains**, add your domain, and click **Verify**. Vercel will perform a DNS lookup and confirm ownership. Once verified, Vercel automatically provisions an SSL certificate and your site becomes accessible at your custom URL.

DNS propagation typically takes between a few minutes and one hour. If verification fails immediately after adding the record, wait 10-15 minutes and try again. You can check propagation status using tools like **dnschecker.org** or the **dig** command-line utility.

6. Technology Stack Reference

Q: What technologies and frameworks does the THEONEWAYGDA project use?

Layer	Technology
Framework	Next.js 16.1.3 with Turbopack and App Router
Language	TypeScript (strict mode)
Database	Neon PostgreSQL with Prisma ORM (49 models, 113 API routes)
Styling	Tailwind CSS 4 with shadcn/ui component library
State	Zustand for client state, Server Components for SSR
Real-time	Server-Sent Events (SSE) for notifications
Deployment	Vercel (edge + serverless), 127 static + dynamic pages
Cron Jobs	10 scheduled tasks for data aggregation and cleanup

Table 2. THEONEWAYGDA technology stack overview